

Your 16-Week Conservative Lean Bulk Program

Start Date: Friday, October 10th, 2025

Your Current Stats:

- Weight: 71 kg (stable for 6 days)
 - Height: 185 cm
 - Body Fat: ~10% (visual estimate, despite Navy method showing 8-9%)
 - Neck: 39 cm | Waist: 78 cm
 - Current Intake: 2,400-2,500 kcal
 - Training Status: Intermediate (1 year consistent, BW squat, BW bench)
 - Physique: "Skinny-lean" appearance despite visible abs
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Phase 1: Maintenance Establishment (Weeks 1-4)

Goal: Find your true maintenance calories and allow metabolic recovery

WEEK 1 (Oct 10-16): Initial Increase

Starting Today (Friday, Oct 10th)

Daily Calories: 2,600 kcal

- Protein: 145g (580 kcal, 22%)
- Fat: 65g (585 kcal, 23%)
- Carbs: 355g (1,420 kcal, 55%)

Why this increase? Your 2,400-2,500 at 71 kg represents suppressed maintenance after cutting. This adds ~150 kcal to begin metabolic recovery while establishing baseline.

What to Expect:

- ▲ Weight jump of 1-2 kg by Monday/Tuesday (glycogen + water - THIS IS NORMAL)
- ⚡ Energy improvement by mid-week
- 🍽️ Slightly increased appetite
- 💪 Better training performance by weekend

Daily Tracking:

- ☐ Morning weight (after bathroom, before eating)
- ☐ Daily food intake in app
- ☐ Subjective energy (1-10 scale)
- ☐ Training performance notes

Action Items:

- ✅ Set up food tracking app if not already using one
- ✅ Take progress photos (front, side, back) in same lighting
- ✅ Measure waist and weight Friday morning
- ✅ Calculate your weekly average weight starting Monday Oct 13

Training Adjustments:

- Continue current split (Mon: Athletic, Tue: Push, Wed: Pull, Fri: Legs, Sat: Upper)
 - Focus on performance and technique
 - If doing cardio: reduce volume by 30-50%
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WEEK 2 (Oct 17-23): Monitoring Phase

Daily Calories: 2,600 kcal (maintain same as Week 1)

- Same macros as Week 1

Key Metrics:

- 📊 Calculate Week 1 average weight (ignore Friday-Tuesday spike, use Wed-Tue average)
- 📊 Compare to Week 2 average weight
- Expected: 0.5-1.0 kg net gain after glycogen stabilization

What to Watch:

- Energy levels normalized?
- Training performance improving?
- Hunger appropriate (not ravenous)?
- Sleep quality good?

Decision Point (Sunday, Oct 23):

- If weight stable or losing: Add 200 kcal for Week 3
- If gaining 0.3-0.7 kg/week: Perfect, maintain calories
- If gaining >1 kg/week: Reduce by 100 kcal

Weekly Tasks:

- ☐ Calculate Week 1 vs Week 2 average weight
- ☐ Note training performance changes
- ☐ Assess subjective recovery (1-10 scale)

WEEK 3 (Oct 24-30): Fine-Tuning

Calories: Adjust based on Week 2 results

Most Likely Scenario: 2,700 kcal

- Protein: 145g (580 kcal)
- Fat: 68g (612 kcal)
- Carbs: 377g (1,508 kcal)

Focus Areas:

- Training intensity should feel significantly better than cutting phase
- Body fullness improving (muscles look fuller, less flat)
- Scale weight trending up slowly but steadily

Biofeedback Checklist:

- Morning energy: 7-8/10 or higher?
- Gym performance: PRs or approaching pre-cut strength?
- Recovery: muscles not constantly sore?
- Mood: stable, not irritable?

If all YES → you're on track

If multiple NO → may need another 100 kcal

WEEK 4 (Oct 31 - Nov 6): Baseline Confirmation

Calories: Hold steady at Week 3 level

End-of-Phase Assessment (Sunday, Nov 6):

Measurements to Take:

- Weight (calculate 4-week average)
- Waist circumference
- Progress photos (same conditions as Week 1)
- Strength benchmarks (test main lifts)

Establishing True Maintenance: Calculate your average weekly weight change over Weeks 2-4:

- If averaging +0.1 to +0.3 kg/week: You're at maintenance ✓
- If losing weight: Add 200 kcal for Phase 2
- If gaining >0.5 kg/week: Reduce by 100 kcal for Phase 2

Decision Point: Based on 4 weeks of data, your true maintenance is likely **2,650-2,750 kcal**

Phase 2: Conservative Surplus (Weeks 5-16)

Goal: Gain 0.25-0.35 kg per week (1.0-1.4 kg per month)

WEEK 5 (Nov 7-13): Surplus Implementation

Daily Calories: 2,850 kcal (assuming 2,700 established maintenance + 150 kcal surplus)

Updated Macros:

- Protein: 150g (600 kcal, 21%)
- Fat: 68g (612 kcal, 21%)
- Carbs: 410g (1,640 kcal, 58%)

Why the increase?

- Adding 200-250 kcal surplus for muscle growth
- Carbs increased most (training fuel and muscle glycogen)
- Protein slightly up to 2.1 g/kg (optimal for surplus)

Target Rate of Gain:

- 📈 0.25-0.35 kg per week
- 📈 ~1.2 kg per month

Training Adjustments:

- Begin progressive overload focus
- Add 1-2 reps or 2.5-5 kg to main lifts when possible
- Volume can increase slightly (1-2 extra sets per muscle group)

New Weekly Habits:

- ☐ Sunday: Calculate weekly average weight
 - ☐ Monday: Plan week's training progressions
 - ☐ Wednesday: Mid-week check-in (energy, performance)
 - ☐ Saturday: Review week, plan next week's nutrition
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WEEKS 6-8 (Nov 14 - Dec 4): Early Gains Phase

Daily Calories: 2,850 kcal (hold steady)

- Same macros as Week 5

Expected Progress by End of Week 8:

- Weight: 73-74 kg (2-3 kg gained from start)
- Body Fat: Still around 10-11% (minimal fat gain)
- Strength: Noticeable improvements in main lifts
- Appearance: Fuller, less "skinny" look

Training Focus:

- Progressive overload every 1-2 weeks
- Track all main lifts (Monday squat, Tuesday bench, Wednesday pull-ups/rows, Friday squat variations, Saturday upper)
- Aim for 10-20 sets per muscle group per week

Monthly Check-in (Sunday, Dec 4):

- ☐ Take progress photos
- ☐ Measure waist (should be 79-80 cm, +1-2 cm)
- ☐ Calculate monthly weight gain (target: 1.0-1.2 kg)
- ☐ Assess body composition visually

Adjustment Protocol:

- If gaining <0.2 kg/week average: Add 100 kcal (increase carbs by 25g)
- If gaining >0.5 kg/week average: Reduce by 100 kcal (decrease carbs by 25g)

- If gaining 0.25-0.4 kg/week: Perfect, maintain current intake
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WEEKS 9-12 (Dec 5 - Jan 1): Mid-Phase Strength Building

Daily Calories: Adjust based on Week 8 results

Most Likely: 2,900-2,950 kcal

- Protein: 150g (600 kcal)
- Fat: 70g (630 kcal)
- Carbs: 420-445g (1,680-1,780 kcal)

Expected Stats by End of Week 12 (Jan 1, 2026):

- Weight: 74-75 kg (+3-4 kg from start)
- Body Fat: 11-12%
- Bench Press: BW for 3-5 reps (or +5-10 kg on 1RM)
- Squat: BW + 10-20 kg
- Appearance: Visibly more muscular, maintained leanness

Training Progression: By this phase, you should be setting PRs regularly. If strength stalls for 2+ weeks:

1. Check if calories sufficient (gaining 0.25+ kg/week?)
2. Evaluate recovery (sleep, stress)
3. Consider deload week if training hard for 8+ weeks straight

Holiday Season Notes (Dec 20-Jan 1):

- Track as best you can

- Don't stress about a few high-calorie days
- Return to normal Jan 2
- Weight may spike 2-3 kg from water/food volume - will normalize in 3-5 days

End of Month 3 Assessment (Jan 1):

- ☐ Photos and measurements
 - ☐ Calculate 3-month total gain (target: 3-4 kg)
 - ☐ Assess body composition (should still see abs clearly)
 - ☐ Evaluate training progress
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WEEKS 13-16 (Jan 2-29): Final Push / Evaluation Phase

Daily Calories: Adjust based on Week 12 results

Most Likely: 3,000-3,050 kcal

- Protein: 150g (600 kcal)
- Fat: 72g (648 kcal)
- Carbs: 445-475g (1,780-1,900 kcal)

Target End Stats (Week 16 - Jan 29, 2026):

- Weight: 75-76 kg (+4-5 kg total from Oct 10)
- Body Fat: 12-13%
- Waist: 80-81 cm (+2-3 cm)
- Lean Mass Gained: 3.0-4.0 kg
- Fat Gained: 1.0-1.5 kg

Appearance Goals:

- No longer "skinny" appearance
- Abs still visible (at least top 4)
- Fuller chest, shoulders, arms
- Better muscle separation
- Improved athletic appearance

Decision Point (Jan 29):**Option A: Continue Bulking (if enjoying gains and still lean)**

- Continue another 8-12 weeks to 78-80 kg
- Monitor body fat doesn't exceed 15%

Option B: Mini-Cut (if approaching 13-14% body fat)

- 4-6 week mini-cut back to 10-11%
- Drop 2-3 kg of fat
- Return to bulking fresher

Option C: Maintenance (if satisfied with current physique)

- Hold at current weight
 - Focus on strength and performance
 - Maintain body composition
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Daily Nutrition Framework

Meal Structure (Flexible - adjust to your preference)

Pre-Workout (2-3 hours before training):

- 80-100g carbs
- 30-40g protein
- Low fat (<10g)
- Example: Oatmeal (80g) with banana and protein shake

Post-Workout (within 2 hours):

- 80-100g carbs (higher GI acceptable)
- 30-40g protein
- Moderate fat okay
- Example: Rice (100g dry), chicken (150g), vegetables

Pre-Sleep:

- 30-40g slow-digesting protein (casein ideal)
- Moderate carbs okay
- Example: Greek yogurt (200g) with berries

Remaining Meals:

- Distribute remaining macros across 2-3 meals
- Focus on whole foods
- Include vegetables daily

Sample Daily Meal Plan (2,850 kcal)

Meal 1 (Breakfast):

- Oats: 100g
- Banana: 1 large
- Peanut butter: 20g
- Whey protein: 30g → 655 kcal | 40g P | 18g F | 85g C

Meal 2 (Pre-Workout):

- White rice: 100g (dry weight)
- Chicken breast: 150g
- Mixed vegetables: 200g
- Olive oil: 10ml → 565 kcal | 48g P | 13g F | 60g C

Meal 3 (Post-Workout):

- Pasta: 120g (dry weight)
- Lean ground beef: 150g
- Tomato sauce: 150g
- Parmesan: 20g → 750 kcal | 55g P | 18g F | 85g C

Meal 4 (Dinner):

- Sweet potato: 300g
- Salmon: 150g
- Broccoli: 200g
- Olive oil: 10ml → 580 kcal | 40g P | 20g F | 60g C

Meal 5 (Pre-Bed):

- Greek yogurt: 200g
- Blueberries: 100g
- Almonds: 20g
- Honey: 15g → 380 kcal | 25g P | 12g F | 45g C

Daily Total: 2,930 kcal | 208g P | 81g F | 335g C

Note: Adjust portion sizes to hit your exact targets. This is a template, not a rigid plan.

Weekly Tracking Template

Copy this for each week:

Week X (Date Range):

Daily Weights:

- Monday: _____ kg
- Tuesday: _____ kg
- Wednesday: _____ kg
- Thursday: _____ kg
- Friday: _____ kg
- Saturday: _____ kg
- Sunday: _____ kg
- **Weekly Average:** _____ kg

Weekly Change: +/- _____ kg

Training Performance:

- Monday (Athletic): Squat _____ kg x _____ reps
- Tuesday (Push): Bench _____ kg x _____ reps
- Wednesday (Pull): Pull-ups _____ reps (weighted: _____ kg)
- Friday (Legs): Main lift _____ kg x _____ reps
- Saturday (Upper): Main lift _____ kg x _____ reps

Biofeedback (1-10 scale):

- Energy Levels: _____/10
- Recovery Quality: _____/10
- Hunger/Satiety: _____/10
- Sleep Quality: _____/10
- Training Motivation: _____/10

Notes:

- Any deviations from plan?
- How do you feel?
- Any concerns?

Next Week Adjustments:

- Calories: _____
 - Training changes: _____
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Troubleshooting Guide

"I'm Not Gaining Weight"

After 2 weeks of no gain:

- Add 200 kcal (50g carbs)
- Ensure you're tracking accurately
- Check if activity increased (NEAT)

"I'm Gaining Too Fast"

If gaining >0.6 kg/week for 2 weeks:

- Reduce 150 kcal (40g carbs)
- Verify you're not just holding water
- Check waist measurements

"My Waist Is Growing Too Fast"

If waist increases >1 cm per month:

- Reduce surplus by 100 kcal
- Increase protein by 20g
- Add 1-2 cardio sessions

"Strength Isn't Increasing"

- Verify you're in surplus (gaining weight?)
- Check sleep (7-9 hours?)
- Consider deload week

- Review training program

"I'm Always Hungry"

- Increase protein to 160-170g
- Add more vegetables (volume)
- Ensure adequate fat intake
- Check if calories too low

"I'm Never Hungry"

- This is normal in surplus
- Don't force-feed excessively
- Focus on nutrient-dense foods
- Liquid calories can help

Monthly Checkpoint Calendar

Month 1 (October 10 - November 6):

-  Establish maintenance
-  Metabolic recovery
-  Weight gain: 1-2 kg (mostly glycogen)

Month 2 (November 7 - December 4):

-  First month in surplus
-  Target gain: 1.0-1.2 kg

- ☒ Strength improvements visible

Month 3 (December 5 - January 1):

- ☒ Continue consistent gain
- ☒ Target gain: 1.0-1.2 kg
- ☒ Visual physique changes clear

Month 4 (January 2 - January 29):

- ☒ Final evaluation phase
 - ☒ Target gain: 0.8-1.0 kg
 - ☒ Decide next steps
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Success Metrics

By Week 4 (Nov 6):

- ☒ True maintenance established
- ☒ Energy fully recovered
- ☒ Training performance normalized

By Week 8 (Dec 4):

- ☒ 2-3 kg gained
- ☒ Strength increased 10-15%
- ☒ Still lean (abs visible)

By Week 12 (Jan 1):

- ☒ 3-4 kg gained

- ☒ Bench press: BW for reps
- ☒ Squat: BW + 15-20 kg
- ☒ Visibly more muscular

By Week 16 (Jan 29):

- ☒ 4-5 kg gained (75-76 kg total)
 - ☒ Body fat: 12-13%
 - ☒ No longer "skinny" appearance
 - ☒ 3.0-4.0 kg lean mass gained
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Your First Action Steps (This Weekend)

Friday, Oct 10 (Today):

1. Take baseline photos (front, side, back, same lighting)
2. Measure waist and weight (morning)
3. Set up food tracking app
4. Calculate your 2,600 kcal meal plan

Saturday, Oct 11:

1. Grocery shopping for Week 1
2. Meal prep if helpful
3. Review training program
4. Set up weekly tracking spreadsheet

Sunday, Oct 12:

1. Finalize Week 1 meal plan
2. Prep first few days of meals
3. Set daily reminders (weigh-in, track food)
4. Mental preparation for the process

Monday, Oct 13:

1. Begin official Week 1
 2. Morning weigh-in
 3. Start 2,600 kcal intake
 4. Training as normal
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Final Mindset Notes

This is a 16-week minimum investment. You've spent time getting lean - now invest the same discipline into building muscle.

The scale will fluctuate 1-3 kg daily. This is water, food volume, and glycogen - not fat gain. Focus on weekly averages.

You will gain some fat. Going from 10% to 12-13% body fat is acceptable and necessary for optimal muscle growth. You'll still look great.

Strength is your best indicator. If lifts are progressing consistently, you're doing it right.

Be patient. Natural muscle gain is slow. 3-4 kg of lean muscle in 4 months is excellent progress.

Trust the process. You've demonstrated discipline during your cut. Apply that same discipline to your bulk, and you'll transform your physique from "skinny-lean" to "athletic-muscular."

Your journey starts today. Let's build.